PROMISE & PRACTICE · UNIT 3 · CHAPTER 5 ASSIGNMENT

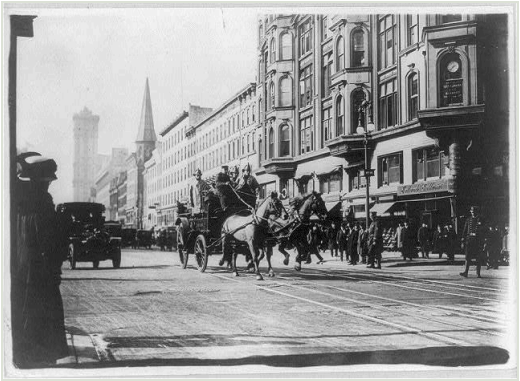
Accident or System?

Cause-and-effect chain · Skill: Accident, or system?

Name _____ **Period** _____ **Date** _____

WHAT I CAN DO TODAY

I can sort causes of the Triangle fire and decide whether it was bad luck or a system that failed.



Horse-drawn fire engines race to the Triangle Shirtwaist Company fire, New York City — photograph, 1911, public domain (Library of Congress)

Directions

On March 25, 1911, a fire at the Triangle Shirtwaist factory in New York killed 146 workers, most of them young immigrant women. Sort the facts, build the chain, then make your call.

1 Sort the causes

Was each fact bad luck, a choice someone made, or a missing rule?

	STATEMENT	BAD LUCK	A CHOICE SOMEONE MADE	A MISSING RULE
1	The fire probably started in a bin of cloth scraps on the 8th floor.	☐	☐	☐
2	Owners kept a stairway door locked to stop workers from taking breaks or stealing.	☐	☐	☐
3	No law required the factory to hold fire drills.	☐	☐	☐
4	Firefighters' ladders reached only to about the 6th floor.	☐	☐	☐
5	The building had only one fire escape, and it collapsed.	☐	☐	☐
6	Workers were paid by the piece, so stopping to leave cost them money.	☐	☐	☐

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2 Build the chain

Put the events in order from first (1) to last (5).

ORDER	EVENT
_____	Workers die or jump from the windows
_____	A fire starts in a scrap bin
_____	Workers rush to exits and find a door locked
_____	New York creates a commission and passes new safety laws
_____	The fire escape collapses under the crowd

3 Make the call

Was the Triangle fire an accident or the result of a system?

Claim

Evidence: use two facts from the sort.

Why does it matter which one it was?

Finished? Turn in this paper the way your teacher asks.

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